

Ram Prasad: a CRM for a defence contract consultant

Read this before you build. It is the problem and the requirements, not a finished plan. Write your own PRD, tech stack and implementation plan from it.

Who he is

Ram Prasad is a defence contract consultant. Government and defence agencies send him requirements; he fulfils them through a network of OEM suppliers. Roughly **25 to 30 enquiries a month**, about **20 quotations**, about **10 orders**, and **20 to 25 active orders** at any time.

Today it runs on Excel, email and memory. Quotation prep takes **3 to 4 days** (partly because it is never urgent), OEM communication **1 to 10 days**, document creation about **1 week**, and follow-ups **3 to 4 hours a day**. History is not searchable, so every new quote starts from scratch.

The central record is the **RFI / tender requirement**. Everything else hangs off it: OEM sourcing, the quote, the PO, PDI and inspection, delivery, payment and commission.

What to build

One requirement, one record, one timeline. Build these in order; the first three are the ones that matter most.

1. Requirement and RFI

- Capture a requirement: customer or agency, product, quantity, required delivery date, technical specifications, tender or enquiry reference, submission deadline and documents.

- One requirement can carry **many line items** (up to 500 part numbers), not one giant text field.
- Statuses: received, qualifying, quoted, submitted, won, lost, cancelled.

2. OEM master and sourcing

- An OEM record: products supplied, capabilities, prices, typical lead time, compliance documents, contacts, past performance, approved or not.
- From a requirement, shortlist the OEMs who can make it, and record each request and its response.

3. Quantity coverage (the hard part)

- Show required quantity against OEM committed quantity, with the **uncovered balance**: 1,000 needed, OEM A 600, OEM B 400, coverage 1,000, uncovered 0.
- Allow several OEMs and several shipments to cover one requirement.
- Distinguish a firm quantity commitment from a mere availability or quote indication. Do not let the team confidently commit to a quantity the OEMs have not covered.

4. Quotation and bid intelligence

- Build a quote from the requirement: OEM price, lead time, target margin, recommended price.
- Before pricing, show **comparable past bids**: what was quoted, whether it was won or lost, and the winning or losing price. He changes the bid from that history.
- Version and approve quotes.

5. Government response and follow-up

- States after submission: submitted, clarification requested, technical clarification, commercial negotiation, awaiting approval, won, lost, cancelled.
- Automatic follow-up tasks, for example no response for seven days, or a request for another document.

6. Order and PO

- Convert an approved quote to an order; the whole history travels with it. No orphan PO: every PO maps to an approved quote.

- Track PO number and date, product, quantity, price, delivery deadline, the OEM selected and the supplier PO, compliance, inspection and PDI requirements.
- One PO can have **multiple invoices**.

7. Fulfilment, PDI and delivery

- A timeline: OEM PO placed, production started, production done, PDI scheduled, PDI passed, government inspection, dispatch, delivered, accepted. Each step has an owner and an expected date.
- PDI is quantified: quantity offered, cleared, rejected. A failed or held PDI can **block dispatch**.
- Support **partial deliveries**, with the outstanding balance visible.
- Flag **delivery risk** early: expected completion against the committed deadline, so he is not asked "where is our order?" before he knows.

8. Payments, commission and documents

- Support partial payments, due dates and reminders. One invoice can be fulfilled by several delivery events.
- Commission is earned on an OEM-payment milestone, subject to the open question below.
- A document and compliance vault: type, supplier, issue date, expiry date, linked product and requirement, with expiry reminders. He keeps approved item lists that renew every 3 to 5 years.

9. Search, history and losses

- Search all history for a comparable requirement, and surface the past OEM, price, delivery time, margin, documents and problems.
- When an opportunity is lost, record a **structured loss reason**: price, technical non-compliance, delivery timeline, competitor preference, quantity or capacity, cancelled, not pursued, other.

10. Dashboard and plain questions

- The morning view answers: how many orders are open and what state each is in, quotes awaiting a response, orders at delivery risk, payments pending, OEM

responses pending, documents expiring.

- He wants to ask in plain language: "how many orders are there?", "how many contracts did we win this month?", "what did we lose?", "why did we lose them?". Answer from the stored data, never invented.

11. Roles, approvals and audit

- Roles: owner or management, sales, operations, finance.
- Approvals where the business needs them on quotes, documents, orders and compliance items.
- An audit trail of material changes: what, who, when.

Rules that must hold

- Every quotation comes from an RFI. Every PO maps to an approved quotation.
- Many line items per requirement; many invoices per PO; many deliveries per invoice.
- Partial deliveries and partial payments are normal, with balances visible.
- Quantity balance is visible across the whole lifecycle: requested, quoted, committed, ready, inspected, invoiced, delivered, accepted.
- PDI cleared is distinct from offered and rejected.
- Repeat requirements reference history; loss reasons are structured.
- OEM commitments are distinct from availability indications.
- Commission follows an OEM-payment milestone.
- Document expiry is trackable and important activity is audited.

Open questions to design around

1. If OEM A can supply 1,000 and 700 is already committed to one order, should the system show only 300 available for another? This decides whether capacity is global or per order.

2. Who invoices whom and who pays the OEM? When is commission actually earned? Confirm with one real transaction.
3. Which documents really consume the one week: generated from data, reused, obtained from the OEM, or prepared by hand?
4. The loss-reason list above is a starting point; confirm the labels he uses.
5. Which historical Excel columns are trustworthy enough to power quote comparison and win or loss analysis?

What NOT to build

- No automatic legal or compliance judgement, and no automatic final bid price.
- No OEM chosen without human approval.
- Not a full accounting or ERP replacement, and not a generic document generator.
- No government-portal automation or auto-messaging as a baseline requirement.

Documents and links

Documents folder (the workbook, the PRD and his sheets)

How this was built (the exact prompts and stack used)

A stack that fits

Front end on **Vercel** or **Netlify** (Next.js), data on **Supabase** or **Neon** (Postgres), auth included. Keep the data in Postgres so it survives a refresh, and separate

what is missing, what failed and what is empty on screen.

Write your own PRD from the requirements above first, then the tech stack, then the implementation plan, then build.